

Clicking on your admin link will take you to the Administrator pane. Note here that in a small window you can see the current SMF version. This is the Administrator's playground from where permissions can be allowed or denied, threads created or deleted, registering and deleting of members achieved, and where the admin exercises all those superpowers we've always associated admins with!

9.3.4 Vanilla

Finally, we take a look at something relatively new, something small, built using PHP and of course MySQL: introducing Vanilla, which is 100% free and 100% open source. We've provided a copy of Vanilla on the CD to get you started. It's also available at <http://get-vanilla.com>.

Download the .zip file, extract it, and copy the entire folder (assuming you've named it "Vanilla") to your "www" folder. In your Web browser, you need to type in the path to the "installer.php" file, which should be in the *Vanilla* root directory. But there's a catch here. Vanilla actually needs you to create a database first manually, unlike the other forum packages we've mentioned here. For this, go to EasyPHP on your taskbar, right-click > Administration > Manage database, and from here the window will look like the screenshot alongside.



Creating a database for Vanilla



A database called Vanilla has just been created